



“It is important to learn the Gen Z lingo, which led to terms such as dumbbell heel and time waist. Humour makes the brand human, shareable”

SANDEEP TANWANI
CMO, PIDILITE



“We have almost 400 million Gen Z consumers in India, and they are indeed driving change and transformation. So, we are reimagining the brands”

PRIYA NAIR
CEO & MD, HUL

104 |

II centres. “Online shopping remains a secondary activity, suggesting that Gen Z separates discovery and transaction journeys across platforms. Overall, this a cohort that is digitally immersed but increasingly discerning, engaging deeply with content while exercising restraint at the point of purchase,” it adds.

In the absence of a precedent or any serious comparison, more effort is needed to understand Gen Z. Raagjeet Garg, Director (Consumer Products Division), L’Oréal India, calls it a “fascinating group” since it represents a

fundamental shift in the Indian consumer DNA. From his position, he thinks they view beauty not as luxury for special occasions but as a daily tool for self-expression.

“They are the curious explorers of the beauty world and not loyal to products just because their parents used it but being hungry for the new. This makes them a high-growth engine as they constantly enter new categories like mascara, sunscreen, serums earlier and more frequently than previous generations,” says Garg.

Within Gen Z or for that mat-

ter, within the same age bracket, interests and preferences can be remarkably different. Mondelez’s Saini speaks of how Cadbury 5Star, a well-known brand in his portfolio, took the counter-culture route with its “Do Nothing” campaign on Valentine’s Day. “The insight was around how youth are facing pressure to be a part of the trend. Now, they could let go of the FOMO (fear of missing out) factor.” In line with Gen Z, the media plan also must be very different. “Just that 30-second ad will not be enough and must be complemented by effective storytelling. Digital is a big part of the piece, and one must look at the time spent by Gen Z on social media,” he says. Of course, digital allows for specific targeting. “In the case of Silk desserts, we can reach out to consumers who are dessert lovers.”

The mobile phone is a key to Gen Z, and Garg says the “unboxing” for them starts long before they touch the physical product. “It is first on the phone, and we realised that to win them over, a product needs to be worthy of stopping them from doomscrolling.” For the Maybelline Colossal Bubble Mascara, L’Oreal, instead of just running commercials, built an immersive Bubble Land to allow them to step into the brand’s world.

To appeal to this audience, Marico has spent time on product innovation to modernise its legacy brands. In the case of Parachute Advanced, trending ingredients such as rosemary and argan oil in lighter textures are used. “We have introduced convenient formats like Saffola Cuppa Oats for on-the-go lifestyles and launched trial-friendly packs for Livon. The process involves blending consumer insights with innovation, ensuring products are functional,

Within Gen Z, or for that matter, within the same age bracket, interests and preferences can be remarkably different